

MIKE E UNDERWOOD

Principal / Staff Solutions Architect

Leesburg, Georgia (Remote-First; Relocation Considered for the Right Role)

+1-770-826-7367 | mikee.underwood@gmail.com

[LinkedIn Profile](#) | [GitHub](#) | mikeeunderwood.dev

Summary

Principal/Staff Solutions Architect with deep experience across systems architecture, enterprise architecture, and digital operations architecture, spanning high-volume payment platforms, CMS modernization, cloud-native engineering, and large-scale integration ecosystems. Combines active, hands-on engineering depth with architectural leadership to shape roadmaps, define service boundaries, modernize legacy systems, and guide cross-functional teams across .NET, Java, Azure, and distributed environments. Recognized for improving reliability, reducing delivery timelines, and aligning technical direction with business strategy across financial services, insurance, and digital consulting organizations.

Core Skills & Technical Expertise

Architecture & System Design

- Systems Architecture, Enterprise Architecture, Digital Operations Architecture
- Domain-Driven Design, SOA, event-driven systems, modular monolith → microservices
- Distributed systems
- API-first design, schema governance, integration patterns, orchestration workflows
- Cloud-native modernization (Azure-first; AWS serverless exposure), hybrid architectures, platform evolution
- Multi-tenant platform design and PCI/HIPAA-aligned architecture

Engineering & Development

- C#, .NET / ASP.NET Core, Java, C++, JavaScript/TypeScript
- SQL Server, Azure SQL, MySQL/MariaDB, Oracle
- REST/JSON APIs, API Design, middleware, service composition, serverless (AWS Lambda)
- React, Vue.js, Node.js, MVC, headless CMS patterns

Cloud, Infrastructure & Operations

- Azure, AWS, Kubernetes, Docker, IIS, Red Hat Linux
- CI/CD governance (Azure DevOps, GitHub Actions), automation, IaC patterns
- Observability architecture: Application Insights, distributed tracing, telemetry pipelines
- SRE-aligned reliability engineering, performance optimization, incident response

Leadership & Delivery

- Architecture governance, roadmap development, TRB/ARB participation
- Cross-functional leadership across engineering, product, security, and infrastructure
- Agile/SDLC governance, DevOps enablement, stakeholder alignment
- Technical communication, mentoring, distributed team collaboration

Experience

Rightpoint Consulting — Remote

Solutions Architect, Digital Operations Architecture (Jan 2020 – Nov 2025)

Designed and delivered enterprise CMS, retail, and e-commerce architectures across Sitecore, Optimizely, and ASP.NET Core, blending hands-on engineering with architectural leadership.

- Architected CMS and digital experience platforms using ASP.NET MVC, React/TypeScript, and headless integration patterns.
- Designed backend payment workflows using .NET Web APIs, AWS Lambda, and Azure Service Bus for reliable, event-driven processing.
- Built cloud deployment architectures across AKS, Azure VMs, and serverless components; implemented CI/CD pipelines and observability instrumentation.
- Authored API specifications, integration contracts, and architectural documentation; collaborated with security teams on HIPAA-aligned integrations.
- Partnered with stakeholders to shape technical roadmaps, evaluate solution tradeoffs, and align delivery with long-term architectural strategy.
- Delivered hands-on development across .NET, JavaScript/TypeScript, React/Vue.js, and cloud services, implementing CMS components, integration layers, and backend workflows.
- Built and optimized production code for ASP.NET Core APIs; React/TypeScript and Vue.js front-ends; and cloud-native services running on AKS, Azure VMs, Azure Functions, and AWS Lambda.
- Developed integration adapters and middleware components supporting payment workflows, retail systems, and headless CMS architectures.
- Diagnosed systemic issues using logs, metrics, and distributed tracing; delivered fixes across APIs, data access, and cloud infrastructure.
- Mentored DEV/QA teams on implementation patterns, debugging, and code quality to preserve architectural intent.

- Used GitHub Copilot and Microsoft Copilot to accelerate development, surface architectural options, and improve code quality.

AXIS Capital — Alpharetta, GA

Application Delivery Lead, Enterprise Architecture (Mar 2018 – Dec 2019)

Led delivery of enterprise software solutions aligned to business and CIO goals, ensuring architectural consistency and adherence to enterprise standards.

- Defined requirements and translated them into application and integration architectures aligned with EA principles and security guidelines.
- Performed code reviews and implemented targeted fixes to ensure alignment with enterprise architecture standards.
- Contributed hands-on code in .NET and Java to support integration workflows, platform enhancements, and production fixes.
- Developed automation scripts and utilities to streamline deployment, testing, and cross-team engineering workflows.
- Served as Scrum Master and team lead, coordinating development activities and ensuring predictable delivery across distributed teams.
- Led offshore DEV/QA teams, providing technical guidance and reviewing implementation approaches.
- Managed delivery budgets, resource planning, and cross-team coordination.
- Collaborated with support teams to troubleshoot production issues and improve system reliability.

Fiserv — Alpharetta, GA

18-year progression across five architecture and engineering roles supporting high-volume payment, billing, and e-bill platforms used by thousands of financial institutions.

Principal Solutions Architect → Manager & Lead Senior Software Architect → Senior Software Architect → Software Architect → Senior Software Engineer

(Systems Architecture, Platform Modernization, Payments & eBill Solutions)

Principal Solutions Architect (Aug 2014 – Feb 2018)

- Partnered with senior leadership to define and maintain a three-year business and technology roadmap for the CheckFreePay division.
- Translated business strategy into system architecture requirements, guiding platform evolution and modernization.
- Chaired the Technical Review Board governing production readiness and architectural compliance.
- Led migration of all Walk-In Payments platform from legacy environments to the go-forward Fiserv data center, including hands-on development (Informix 4GL/C → C#), scripting modernization (Unix → PowerShell), and database migration (Informix → SQL Server).
- Designed barcode-based Walk-In Payments workflows and the supporting .NET Web Service APIs that enabled retail point-of-sale payment capture and error-free transaction processing.
- Delivered hands-on engineering during modernization efforts, rewriting legacy Informix 4GL/C components into C#, modernizing Unix scripts into PowerShell, and building new .NET Web Service APIs.
- Implemented backend logic and data-access layers supporting barcode-based Walk-In Payments workflows and POS integrations
- Ensured architectural compliance across PCI-regulated payment workflows and audit-driven operational controls, partnering with security and operations teams to maintain certification readiness.
- Redesigned compliance reporting and monitoring, achieving 100% reporting accuracy.

Manager & Lead Senior Software Architect (Mar 2012 – Jul 2014)

- Led modernization initiatives and delivery of a .NET Web Service API layer across .NET and Java products.
- Reviewed and refactored .NET and Java components, ensuring consistency across the API modernization program.
- Contributed code prototypes and implementation spikes to validate architectural direction and accelerate modernization initiatives.
- Defined and maintained a three-year business roadmap and supporting architecture roadmap.
- Partnered with senior leadership to align architectural direction with business strategy and operational goals.
- Managed the Biller Solutions architecture team, including hiring, coaching, and performance evaluation.

Senior Software Architect (Sep 2008 – Feb 2012)

- Served on the Architecture Review Board, shaping new Biller Solutions initiatives and integration patterns.
- Designed and delivered the eBill Easy Activation platform, increasing consumer adoption by 230%.
- Built a cross-platform authentication mechanism reducing digital certificates from hundreds to one.
- Designed the .NET SaaS Web Service API that became the foundation for eBill capabilities used by 4,000+ financial sponsors, Bank of America, and MyCheckFree.com.
- Built the .NET eBill platform that reduced implementation timelines from nine months to two.
- Led architecture and delivery of the responsive MyCheckFree.com mobile experience and supporting Java REST APIs.
- Developed .NET and Java services powering eBill activation, authentication, and mobile experiences.
- Built reusable integration components and service libraries that reduced onboarding timelines and improved reliability.

Software Architect (Jul 2001 – Aug 2008)

- Founding member of an Agile innovation group focused on rapid prototyping of new payment and billing concepts.
- Designed and delivered multiple Java and ASP.NET payment solutions, several commercialized or sold to third parties.
- Designed a Java biller-direct payment and presentment platform integrating iSeries and mainframe systems.
- Co-designed a .NET-based SOA exposing mainframe capabilities; served as lead architect for eBill services.

- Led ASP.NET initiatives including ACH orchestration, correspondence systems, and consumer payment flows.
- Delivered hands-on engineering across Java and ASP.NET, building payment flows, ACH orchestration, correspondence systems, and biller-direct integrations.
- Developed SOA components and integration adapters bridging mainframe, iSeries, and distributed systems.

Senior Software Engineer (Dec 1999 – Jun 2001)

- Implemented client-side and server-side integration code for SSO, hosted payment flows, and custom eBill solutions.
- Delivered client integration solutions for CheckFree's eBill and payment systems, ranging from SSO to full hosted implementations.
- Built utilities, adapters, and automation scripts to accelerate customer onboarding and reduce delivery friction.
- Developed project plans, estimates, and integration approaches in collaboration with sales and project management teams.

Earlier Career

RIB Software (BSD) – Senior Software Engineer

Sales Technologies – Software Engineer

Universal Microsystems – Software Engineer

Education

Master of Science, Computer Information Systems

Georgia State University, J. Mack Robinson College of Business

BBA, Computer Information Systems

Georgia State University, J. Mack Robinson College of Business

Certifications

Sitecore Experience Solution 9 Developer